

GRAMMAR REVIEW WORKBOOK

Present & Past Tenses

Simple vs. Continuous · Level A1+ · 100-minute lesson

 100 minutes

 Level A1+

 Grammar + Practice + Speaking

0–5 min	Warm-up
5–20 min	Grammar Review 1 — Present Simple vs. Present Continuous
20–40 min	Practice 1
40–55 min	Grammar Review 2 — Past Simple vs. Past Continuous
55–75 min	Practice 2
75–90 min	Mixed Review (all four tenses)
90–100 min	Speaking Wrap-up

✓ **Answer with a partner**

1. What are you doing right now?
2. What do you usually do on Saturdays?
3. What did you do yesterday evening?
4. What were you doing at 8 p.m. last night?

Present Simple vs. Present Continuous

5–20
min

Present Simple

Habits, routines, facts, permanent situations, schedules.

I / You / We / They **work** → don't work → Do ... work?
He / She / It **works** → doesn't work → Does ... work?

Markers: always, usually, often, sometimes, never, every day/week/year, on Mondays

- She **works** in a hospital.
- I **don't drink** coffee.
- **Does** he **speak** French?
- The train **leaves** at 9 a.m. every morning.

Present Continuous

Actions happening now, temporary situations, fixed future arrangements.

subject + **am / is / are** + verb-**ing**

Markers: now, right now, at the moment, today, this week/month, look!, listen!

- I **am studying** English right now.
- They **aren't watching** TV at the moment.
- **Is** she **cooking** dinner now?
- We **are meeting** Tom on Friday.

Present Simple

I **play** tennis every Sunday.

He **works** in a bank.

Present Continuous

I **am playing** tennis now.

He **is working** on a report today.

1 Circle the correct form

1. She usually (walks / is walking) to school.
2. Look! It (rains / is raining) outside.
3. We (don't watch / aren't watching) TV every night.
4. He (doesn't work / isn't working) at the moment — he's on holiday.
5. My parents (visit / are visiting) us every summer.

2 Fill in the gaps (present simple or present continuous)

1. Tom usually ____ (get up) at 7 a.m., but today he ____ (sleep) late.
2. ____ you ____ (like) pizza?
3. Right now, the children ____ (play) in the garden.
4. My sister ____ (not / drink) coffee. She prefers tea.
5. Listen! Someone ____ (knock) on the door.
6. Water ____ (boil) at 100°C.
7. We ____ (study) for our exam this week.
8. He ____ (never / arrive) late.

3 Write your own sentences

Write 4 sentences: 2 with present simple (a habit and a fact) and 2 with present continuous (something happening now and a future arrangement).

Past Simple

Finished actions/events at a specific time in the past.

Regular: verb + **-ed** (worked, played)

Irregular: went, saw, had, did

Negative: **didn't** + base verb · Question: **Did** + subject + base verb?

Markers: yesterday, last night/week/year, ago, in 2010, when I was a child

- I **watched** a film last night.
- She **didn't go** to school yesterday.
- **Did** you **see** that movie?
- He **went** to Spain two years ago.

Past Continuous

Actions in progress at a specific past moment; background action interrupted by another.

subject + **was / were** + verb-**ing**

Markers: while, when, at 8 o'clock yesterday, all day yesterday

- I **was sleeping** at midnight.
- They **weren't listening** to the teacher.
- **What were** you **doing** when I called?
- The phone **rang** while I **was having** a shower.

Past Simple

I **finished** my homework at 9 p.m.

Past Continuous

I **was doing** my homework at 8 p.m.

She **called** me while I **was cooking**. (*interruption + background*)

1 Circle the correct form

1. While I (walked / was walking) home, it started to rain.
2. He (watched / was watching) TV all evening yesterday.
3. They (didn't go / weren't going) to the party last night.
4. What (did you do / were you doing) at 7 p.m. yesterday?
5. She (broke / was breaking) her leg while she (skied / was skiing).

2 Fill in the gaps (past simple or past continuous)

1. When I _____ (arrive) home, my brother _____ (watch) TV.
2. Yesterday I _____ (go) to the market and _____ (buy) some fruit.
3. While she _____ (study), the lights _____ (go) out.
4. We _____ (not / see) each other last year.
5. _____ you _____ (sleep) when the earthquake happened?
6. He _____ (live) in Rome from 2015 to 2018.
7. They _____ (walk) in the park when it _____ (start) to rain.
8. I _____ (not / hear) the phone because I _____ (have) a shower.

3 Sentence combination

Combine each pair of sentences using **while** or **when** and past simple/past continuous.

1. I was reading a book. My friend called me.
2. The children were playing outside. It started to rain.
3. She was cooking dinner. The fire alarm rang.

1 Choose the correct tense

1. I usually (go / am going) to work by bus, but today I ____ (drive).
2. She ____ (write) a letter when the power ____ (go) out.
3. Look! The dog ____ (chase) the cat!
4. Last summer, we ____ (travel) to Italy.
5. He ____ (not / like) horror films.
6. What ____ you ____ (do) at this time yesterday?
7. My father ____ (work) as an engineer.
8. While I ____ (wait) for the bus, I ____ (see) an old friend.

2 Short story gap-fill

Every day, Anna ____ (take, present simple) the 8 a.m. train to work. Yesterday, however, she ____ (miss, past simple) it because she ____ (talk, past continuous) to her neighbour when the train ____ (arrive, past simple) at the station. Right now, she ____ (wait, present continuous) for the next train, and she ____ (think, present continuous) about how she can be on time tomorrow. She ____ (never / be, present simple) late for a meeting, so this ____ (be, present simple) a new problem for her.

✓ **In pairs, take turns answering**

1. Describe your typical morning routine (present simple).
2. Describe what is happening in your classroom right now (present continuous).
3. Tell your partner about something interesting you did last weekend (past simple).
4. Tell your partner what you were doing at exactly 10 p.m. last night (past continuous).

Teacher's Answer Key

Part 1, Exercise 1

1. walks 2. is raining 3. don't watch 4. isn't working 5. visit

Part 1, Exercise 2

1. gets up / is sleeping 2. Do, like 3. are playing 4. doesn't drink 5. is knocking 6. boils 7. are studying
8. never arrives

Part 2, Exercise 1

1. was walking 2. watched 3. didn't go 4. were you doing 5. broke / was skiing

Part 2, Exercise 2

1. arrived / was watching 2. went / bought 3. was studying / went 4. didn't see 5. Were, sleeping 6. lived
7. were walking / started 8. didn't hear / was having

Part 2, Exercise 3 (sample answers)

1. I was reading a book when my friend called me.
2. The children were playing outside when it started to rain.
3. She was cooking dinner when the fire alarm rang.

Part 3, Exercise 1

1. go / am driving 2. was writing / went 3. is chasing 4. travelled 5. doesn't like 6. were, doing 7. works
8. was waiting / saw

Part 3, Exercise 2

takes / missed / was talking / arrived / is waiting / is thinking / has never been / is